

Pune-based IT employees' association Nascent Information Technology Employees Senate (NITES). Qness IT Staffing CEO Vijay Sivaram expects a drop in fresher hiring and increased demand for mid-level talent: "It is easier to navigate economic uncertainties with skilled talent than with freshers and entry-level talent where companies have to spend on training them." Infosys, TCS, Wipro, HCL, Tech Mahindra and Mphasis did not respond to BT's queries about fresher on-boarding status and overall hiring plans.

The headwinds in the IT and tech sector are driven by multiple

2021, has been battered, with funding drying up, layoffs becoming the norm and hiring slowing to a trickle.

But there are bright spots, too.

**T**HE INDIAN ECONOMY is doing well, and so jobs in non-tech sectors are aplenty. As India's high-frequency indicators of PMI, IIP and eight core indices paint a bright picture of the economy, opportunities have opened in sectors such as banking, consulting, pharma, retail and FMCG. Naukri's analysis shows that the hiring activity mix shifted towards

which employs 130,000 people, is seeing maximum attrition in the non-supervisory employee category, says CHRO Vinay Razdan. For Axis Bank, which ranked No. 7 and employs 90,000, the way to counter talent retention challenges is by first filling up roles internally. "The big learning is that the talent is with you. Give them the opportunity before the external market does," says CHRO Rajkamal Vempati.

Then, tech talent itself continues to be in demand in non-tech sectors. Bector says the demand is particularly for AI, ML and analytics. "We've built a 350-member team in



**"ORGANISATIONS HAVE REALISED THAT TO STAY RELEVANT AS AN EMPLOYER OF CHOICE, THEY MUST ADAPT TO THE WORKFORCE [OF TODAY]"**

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**"THERE HAVE BEEN INSTANCES OF FIRMS RESCINDING JOB OFFERS, REDUCING SALARIES, LAYING OFF EMPLOYEES AND IMPLEMENTING EXTENDED WORKING HOURS"**

**HARPREET SINGH  
SALUJA**  
PRESIDENT, NITES

reasons, one of which is inflated employee-related costs because of excess hiring when post-pandemic digitisation demand was at its peak, says Sivaram. "There is extra pressure impacting the global tech sector and India being the host of a large amount of tech talent will not be decoupled from this," he says. The start-up space, especially, which saw dizzying funding and valuations in

domestic economy-driven sectors in the second half of 2022. "All across the world, we were hiring because we were ramping up capacity," says Vikram Bector, President & CHRO of pharma major Piramal Group, which also has a presence in real estate and financial services.

The opportunities are also causing a churn, agree HR heads. HDFC Bank, No. 5 in BT's ranking and

Bengaluru, which is the hub for our tech function in our retail finance business. We have an equally large business intelligence team of people who do all the analytics," he says, adding that Piramal Group's attrition has been falling for the past four-five months, but also points out these can be attributed to a combination of internal efforts and market conditions.